Step Seven of Nine: Where Getting Application-Ready Fits When You're Planning Ahead for Dad

The nine steps of the Medicaid Planning Roadmap, with yours marked.

You're keeping Dad's records in order in case he ever applies for Medicaid. It helps to see where that file fits: it belongs to one step of nine, and for a family planning ahead it's a step taken at an easy pace.

This page shows the whole road, where this step sits on it, and who is involved after it.

Phase 1 · Assess

Understand where you are today.

1. **Understand** Care Needs → Levels of Care & Costs → Care Plan
   You finish with: Future Care Planning Assessment
2. **Organize** Income & Assets → Ownership & Expenses → Financial File
   You finish with: Family Financial Inventory
3. **Assess** Care & Nonfinancial Eligibility → Income & Assets → Barriers & Readiness
   You finish with: Medicaid Readiness Assessment

Phase 2 · Plan

Develop and implement your strategy.

4. **Plan** Barriers & Issues → Priorities & Professional Team → Written Plan
   You finish with: Advance Medicaid Planning Roadmap
5. **Legal** Authority & Documents → Property, Trusts & Transfers → Attorney Review
   You finish with: Legal Planning Review
6. **Financial** Costs & Runway → Asset Treatment & Tools → Strategy & Documentation
   You finish with: Long-Term Care Funding Plan

Phase 3 · Secure

Secure benefits, protect assets, and maintain eligibility.

7. **Apply** Prepare → Submit → Manage
   You finish with: Medicaid Application-Ready File

   You are here. For a family planning ahead, this step is about getting ready, not applying. The step as a whole runs Prepare, Submit, Manage, and you are in the first part only. It's finished when the family has an application-ready file and knows what needs to happen when the time comes to seek Medicaid benefits.
8. **Protect** What May Be Protected → What May Remain Exposed → What Needs Ongoing Attention
   You finish with: Asset Protection Assessment

9 **Maintain** Ongoing Requirements → Changes & Renewals → Maintenance System
You finish with: Medicaid Monitoring & Maintenance System

What this step produces

A Medicaid Application-Ready File: the records that exist and where each is kept, a running history of the larger money events, who would be responsible for an eventual application, the professionals the family would call, and the date it was last updated. It is a family's records, organized. It isn't an application, and it doesn't establish that Dad is or would be eligible for anything.

What happens next

For now, mostly upkeep. The file is added to as statements arrive and things change. Along the way, your Medicaid planner explains the general application process and which records the file should hold, and reviews the family's record-keeping system and who would be responsible for an eventual application.

If the time comes to apply, your Medicaid planner reviews readiness with the family first, and an applications specialist is brought in for the application itself. The application goes to the state: Medicaid.gov tells people to contact their state Medicaid agency to apply, and the federal Administration for Community Living notes that states take the applications and make the eligibility determinations. [1] [2]

After Apply come the last two steps, Protect and Maintain. For a family planning ahead, those may be a long way off.

Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: finding the records, noting where each is kept, keeping the file current.
- Dad: his records, his say over who sees them, and his choice of who would handle an application.
- Your Medicaid planner: explains the general application process and which records an application-ready file should hold, reviews the family's record-keeping system, and reviews readiness with the family before any eventual application.
- An applications specialist: brought in when it is time to apply, to prepare the application with the family.
- The state Medicaid agency: takes applications and decides eligibility.
- An elder law attorney: legal advice and legal documents, if a question in the file turns out to be a legal one.

What this page doesn't promise

How long any step takes, who will be available, whether or when Dad would apply, or how an application would turn out. Families move through the steps at different speeds, and rules vary by state. Nothing on this page is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this step sits, what it produces and who is involved after it. The planning interview is the next thing to do from here: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's own. Where an application goes, and who decides it, follow Medicaid.gov and the federal Administration for Community Living.

1. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (Medicaid.gov), Where Can People Get Help With Medicaid & CHIP?
2. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare.gov), Applying for Medicaid